

Nāma-Tattva — Why My Chanting Isn't Working (and How to Fix It)

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Why My Chanting Isn't Working (and How to Fix It)

A Diagnostic Guide to the Holy Name

compiled by Sreenivas Gopal Dāsa (Sreenivas Mallipeddi)

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A Note on Sources & Method (*please read*)

This book follows the paramparā principle: its teachings are grounded in śāstra (revealed scripture) and in the commentaries of the ācāryas — not in personal speculation. Two honest clarifications belong here, so the reader knows exactly what they are holding:

1. **The diagnostic framework is a teaching device, not a single named scripture.** The organizing chain of this book —

Guṇas → Ṣaḍ-Ripu (six enemies) → Anarthas → Pāpa → Aparādhā → the Blocked Name — is a **pedagogical synthesis** assembled by the compiler from teachings that are individually scriptural. Each *link* is traditional; the *sequence and the clinical framing* are an editorial aid to understanding, offered as a lens, not presented as a verse or a fixed śāstric list. Where the book says "no speculation," it means every *claim* is sourced — not that the *arrangement* is itself revealed.

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English translations of verses from *Bhagavad-gītā As It Is*, *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*, and *Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta* follow the editions of **His Divine Grace A.C.**

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All glories to Śrīla Prabhupāda, whose translations opened these scriptures to the world.

Contemporary teachings

The "From the lectures" passages and the contemporary-teacher epigraphs summarize or quote recorded Holy-Name lectures by **HH Sacīnandana Swami Mahārāja**, **HG Vaiśeṣika Prabhu**, **HG Bhūrijana Prabhu**, and **HG Mahātmā Prabhu**, transcribed from public recordings (ISKCON Desire Tree) with automatic speech recognition and compiled into study notes. Transcripts and notes are openly available at <https://github.com/SreeGD/sadhana-setu>.

Attributions are the compiler's. Direct quotations are drawn verbatim from the transcripts; "(as taught)" lines are the compiler's faithful summaries. Because the transcripts are machine-generated and may contain errors, **these attributions are provisional pending the review and consent of the respective teachers or their representatives** before any published edition.

Transliteration

Sanskrit is given in IAST (International Alphabet of Sanskrit Transliteration). Chapter-title Sanskrit terms and all transliterations are to receive a final review by a Sanskrit scholar prior to print.

Dedication

Dedicated to His Divine Grace A.C. Bhaktivedanta Swami Prabhupāda, Founder-Ācārya of the International Society for Krishna Consciousness, who carried the chanting of the Holy Names to the world.

Invocation

om ajñāna-timirāndhasya jñānāñjana-śalākayā
cakṣur unmīlitaṁ yena tasmai śrī-gurave namaḥ

I was born in the darkest ignorance, and my spiritual master opened my eyes with the torch of knowledge. I offer my respectful obeisances unto him.

śrī-śrī-guru-gaurāṅgau jayataḥ — All glories to Śrī Guru and Gaurāṅga.

Chapter 1 • Nāma-Prabhāva — The Transcendental Power of the Holy Name

"In these transcendental names You have invested all Your transcendental energies, and there is no hard and fast rule for chanting them." — Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu, Śikṣāṣṭaka 2

1.1 The Supreme Statement — Śikṣāṣṭaka 2

Devanāgarī

नाम्नाम् अकारि बहुधा निज-सर्व-शक्तिस्
तत्रार्पिता नियमितः स्मरणे न कालः।
एतादृशी तव कृपा भगवन् ममापि
दुर्दैवम् ईदृशम् इहाजनि नानुरागः॥

IAST

nāmnām akāri bahudhā nija-sarva-śaktis
tatrārpitā niyamitaḥ smaraṇe na kālaḥ
etādṛśī tava kṛpā bhagavan mamāpi
durdaivam īdṛśam ihājani nānurāgaḥ

Translation. "O my Lord, Your holy name alone can render all benediction to living beings, and thus You have hundreds and millions of names like Kṛṣṇa and Govinda. In these transcendental names You have invested all Your transcendental energies, and there is no hard and fast rule for chanting them. Out of Your causeless mercy You have made approach to You easy through Your holy names, but I am so unfortunate that I have no attraction for them."

Word-by-word

Sanskrit	IAST	Meaning
नाम्नाम्	nāmnām	of the names

Sanskrit	IAST	Meaning
अकारि	akāri	manifested
बहुधा	bahudhā	in many ways
निज-सर्व-शक्तिः	nija-sarva-śaktiḥ	all His own potencies
तत्र अर्पिता	tatra arpitā	invested therein
नियमितः ... न कालः	niyamitaḥ ... na kālāḥ	no strict rule of time
एतादृशी तव कृपा	etādr̥śī tava kṛpā	such is Your mercy
दुर्दैवम्	durdaivam	misfortune
न अनुरागः	na anurāgaḥ	no attraction

Two revolutionary claims sit inside one verse: **(1)** the Lord has invested *all* His potencies (*nija-sarva-śakti*) into His name; and **(2)** there is *no restriction* (*niyamitaḥ na kālāḥ*) — no qualification of time, place, caste, or purity is required to chant. Everything Vedic ritual gates behind rules, the holy name throws open.

1.2 The Name Is the Person — *Abhinnatva*

Padma Purāṇa

नाम चिन्तामणिः कृष्णश्चैतन्य-रस-विग्रहः।
पूर्णः शुद्धो नित्य-मुक्तोऽभिन्नत्वान्नाम-नामिनोः॥

nāma cintāmaṇiḥ kṛṣṇaś caitanya-rasa-vigrahaḥ
pūrṇaḥ śuddho nitya-mukto 'bhinnatvān nāma-nāminoḥ

"The holy name is a wish-fulfilling gem (*cintāmaṇi*), the very embodiment of consciousness and bliss (*caitanya-rasa-vigraha*) — complete, pure, eternally liberated, because the name and the named are non-different (*abhinnatvāt nāma-nāminoḥ*)."

This is the hinge of the whole book. An ordinary name merely *points* to its object — the word "water" cannot wet the tongue. The holy name does not point; it **delivers the Person**. When the tongue says *Kṛṣṇa*, *Kṛṣṇa* Himself is present there.

From the lectures. Sacinandana Swami Mahārāja develops exactly this in "The Living Name": the name is not a symbol but *Kṛṣṇa present as a person* — which is why our chanting can be lifeless even while the name is fully alive. Vaiśeṣika Prabhu grounds the same point in *śruti-pramāṇa*: the name is spiritual sound descending from beyond the material universe, not an ordinary vibration.

1.3 The Name Acts Even in Its Shadow — SB 6.2.14

साङ्केत्यं पारिहास्यं वा स्तोभं हेलनम् एव वा।
वैकुण्ठ-नाम-ग्रहणम् अशेषाघ-हरं विदुः॥

sāṅketyaṁ pārihāsyāṁ vā stobhaṁ helanam eva vā
vaikuṇṭha-nāma-grahaṇam aśeṣāgha-haraṁ viduḥ

"Chanting the name of the Lord of Vaikuṇṭha — even to indicate something else (*sāṅketya*), jokingly (*pārihāsyā*), for musical entertainment (*stobha*), or neglectfully (*helana*) — destroys unlimited sins. This is the verdict of the learned."

Even the *shadow* of the name (*nāmābhāsa*) burns unlimited sins. If the weakest, most careless contact is that potent, the case for attentive, devotional chanting makes itself. (We return to *nāmābhāsa* systematically in Chapter 8.)

1.4 The Seven Glories of the Holy Name

#	Glory	Sanskrit	Meaning
1	Non-different	अभिन्नत्व	The name is Kṛṣṇa
2	All-powerful	सर्व-शक्तिमान्	Full potency invested
3	Unlimited	बहुधा	Countless names
4	Accessible	नियमितः न	No hard-and-fast rule
5	All-merciful	कृपा	Approach made easy
6	All-benediction	सर्व-मङ्गल	Gives every blessing
7	Self-manifesting	स्वयं-स्फूर्ति	Reveals itself to the willing

Four analogies for these glories.

- **Sun and sunlight (abhinnatva).** To stand in sunlight is to feel the sun itself — not a symbol of it. To chant is to be in Kṛṣṇa's presence.
- **The touchstone (cintāmaṇi).** A material touchstone turns iron to gold; the name gives what the soul actually needs — love of God — like a king pressing the whole kingdom on one who asked for rice.
- **The ocean in a drop (sarva-śakti).** All of Kṛṣṇa's infinite potencies are compressed into the sixteen words of the mahā-mantra.
- **The mother's call (no restriction).** A child may cry "Mother!" at any moment, in any state; the Lord has made His name just that available — even to one who is falling (Ajāmila — Chapter 2).

1.5 Why This Chapter Comes First

The rest of the book is a rescue operation for a chanter who feels nothing. That entire project rests on one fact established here: **the failure is never in the name.** The sun is always full; if we feel no warmth, the sky is clouded on *our* side. Fix that firmly, and every later chapter — the enemies, the offenses, the diagnosis, the cure — becomes hopeful work rather than despair.

→ Next: the name's power is not theory — Chapter 2 shows six lives it visibly transformed.

Chapter 2 • Nāma-Uddhāra — Lives Transformed by the Holy Name

"Chanting the name of the Lord — even to indicate something else, jokingly, for music, or neglectfully — frees one from unlimited sins." — Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 6.2.14 (Śukadeva Gosvāmī)

The power described in Chapter 1 is not abstract. Scripture records specific people whom the name lifted from ruin — evidence that the name acts by *its own* potency, not by the qualification of the chanter.

2.1 Ajāmila — the fallen brāhmaṇa (SB 6.1–3)

A learned brāhmaṇa wrecked by bad association, Ajāmila lived for years as a thief and debauchee. At death, terrified by the Yamadūtas, he cried out the name of his youngest son — *Nārāyaṇa*.

patitaḥ skhalito bhagnaḥ sandaṣṭas tapta āhataḥ
harir ity avaśenāha pumān nārhati yātanāḥ (SB 6.2.15)

"One who chants 'Hari' even helplessly — while falling, slipping, breaking a bone, bitten, burned, or struck — is freed from all reactions."

The Viṣṇudūtas intervened; given a second chance, Ajāmila purified himself and attained liberation. **Teaching:** even *sāṅketya* (indirect) chanting saved a sinful man at death's door.

2.2 Gajendra — the king of elephants (SB 8.2–4)

Intoxicated with strength and followers, Gajendra found every material asset useless against the crocodile. After a thousand years he cried out to the Lord alone (SB 8.3) — and the Lord came on Garuḍa, killed the crocodile, and gave him a spiritual form. **Teaching:** crisis becomes opportunity when the soul finally calls out sincerely rather than relying on its own strength.

2.3 Prahlāda — the child devotee (SB 7)

Born in a demon dynasty, taught to hate Viṣṇu, Prahlāda simply kept chanting and remembering Kṛṣṇa — "absorbed in the great nectar of Your glories, I fear nothing" (SB 7.9.43). Fire, poison, cliffs, and elephants could not touch him; the Lord appeared as Nṛsimhadeva to protect His devotee. **Teaching:** pure chanting is an impenetrable shelter.

2.4 Dhruva — the determined prince (SB 4.8–12)

A five-year-old sought a kingdom through austerity, chanting the mantra Nārada gave him. When the Lord appeared, Dhruva said, "*I was searching for broken glass and You have given me a priceless jewel — I want no benediction*" (Dhruva's prayer, *Hari-bhakti-sudhodaya* 7.28, cited in Prabhupāda's purport to SB 4.9.5). **Teaching:** the name purifies desire itself — even a material motive matures into prema.

2.5 Mṛgārī — the hunter (Cc. Madhya 24)

A cruel hunter who half-killed animals for sport, taught by Nārada to chant, wept in repentance, freed the animals, and became so compassionate he stepped over ants. **Teaching:** the most cruel heart becomes the most tender through the name.

2.6 Jagāi & Mādhāi — the drunkards of Navadvīpa (Cc. Ādi 17)

The worst ruffians of the town — who even wounded Nityānanda Prabhu — were delivered by His causeless mercy and never returned to sin. **Teaching:** the mercy of the devotees joined to the name can save anyone.

Summary

Devotee	Contact with the Name	Result
Ajāmila	indirect, at death	liberated
Gajendra	crisis prayer	spiritual body
Prahlāda	constant remembrance	fully protected
Dhruva	guru-given mantra	desire purified

Devotee	Contact with the Name	Result
Mrgāri	instruction	cruelty → compassion
Jagāi–Mādhāi	devotee's mercy	pure devotees

From the lectures. The corpus is itself a gallery of such lives: Bhūrijana Prabhu builds an entire seminar on **Ajāmila** as the supreme atonement; Sacīnandana Swami Mahārāja retells **Haridāsa Ṭhākura** the Nāmācārya, **Kholāvecā Śrīdhara**, and **Nārada's** path from loss to longing; Vaiśeṣika Prabhu recounts **Vālmīki**, transformed from bandit to sage by chanting even "mara" ("death"), which became "Rāma."

The through-line: the name is not limited by the chanter's qualifications. It acts according to its own power upon anyone who touches it sincerely — which is precisely why *my* case (Chapter 3) is never hopeless.

→ Next: if the name is this powerful, why does my own chanting so often feel empty?

Chapter 3 • Nāma-Vighna — Why My Chanting Doesn't Seem to "Work"

"The holy name is fully alive — Kṛṣṇa present as a person — yet our chanting is so often lifeless, done from habit rather than from a living, tasted experience." — HH Sacinandana Swami Mahārāja (as taught in "The Living Name" retreat)

3.1 A Devotee's Story

(A composite drawn from experiences common to serious practitioners.)

Kṛṣṇa Dāsa had chanted sixteen rounds daily for fifteen years — regular in temple attendance, strict in the four principles, faithful in his reading. Yet inside he felt empty.

"Why is this not working?" he asked his spiritual master, voice breaking. "Fifteen years. No taste, no tears, no absorption. My mind still wanders the whole round. I still get angry at home. I still criticize other devotees in my mind. What am I doing wrong?"

His guru answered with questions:

- **"When you chant, where is your mind?"** — "Planning the day. Replaying arguments. Sometimes I finish a round and don't remember chanting a single mantra."
- **"Are you calling to Kṛṣṇa, or completing a quota?"** — "Honestly? A quota. I'm relieved when it's done."
- **"When a devotee errs, what is your first thought?"** — Silence. Then: "That they're doing it wrong. That I know better. Sometimes I feel satisfied when they fail."
- **"Do you truly believe the name can transform you — or do you secretly doubt it?"** — "After fifteen years of no experience... maybe I wonder if it only works for special devotees."

"You have named four of the ten offenses," his guru said, "in a single conversation."

3.2 The Diagnosis

Symptom he described	Offense	Underlying enemy
Mind elsewhere; chanting as a quota	#10 — inattentive, attached chanting	kāma
Criticizing devotees, even mentally	#1 — offense to a devotee	mātsarya
Secret doubt of the name's power	#5 — the glories are "exaggeration"	moha
"I know better; I've done everything right"	pride (mada)	mada

The name had not failed him for fifteen years. **Offenses had curtained it.**

bhagavan-nāmnī saṁprāpte 'parādhe sati tat-prabhāvaṁ na darśayati
(rendering the teaching of the Mādhurya-kādambinī)

"When an offense is present, the holy name does not reveal its full potency to the offender."

The name is Kṛṣṇa Himself (Chapter 1). When we offend, He simply withholds the *experience* of His power — the chanting still purifies, but at reduced perception — while we persist, the cloud thins.

3.3 The Prescription — and the Turn

Over a year, under guidance, Kṛṣṇa Dāsa worked *one* cloud at a time: a daily meditation on *tṛṇād api sunīcena*; finding three good qualities in every devotee; pre-japa settling and one slow, fully-heard round; reading a transformation story daily to rebuild faith; and concrete service to the very devotees he had criticized.

The change was not dramatic. But gradually: tears came unbidden in one attentive round; he found himself praising devotees he had envied; work stopped colonizing his japa; he began to *want* to chant.

"The name didn't change," his guru observed. "**You** changed — by removing what blocked it."

From the lectures. Sacinandana Swami Mahārāja names the same gap — the scriptures heap glory on the name, yet the practitioner tastes little; the "steel-framed heart" that sheds no tear is the diagnostic. Vaiśeṣika Prabhu warns of "japa-fade": attention diverts by degrees until the practice quietly dies. Both point past the symptom to a *nameable* cause.

3.4 Where This Book Goes

This chapter recognized the problem in a story. The rest of the book makes it operable:

- **Part Two (Ch 4–8)** — the full chain that blocks the name.
- ★ **Chapter 9** — a self-diagnosis: find *my own* cloud.
- **Part Three (Ch 10–16)** — the cure, method by method.
- **Part Four (Ch 17–21)** — what freedom and prema actually look like.

→ *Next: to diagnose the blockage, first understand it — beginning with why the enemies arise at all.*

Chapter 4 • Śaḍ-Ripu — The Six Enemies: Why They Arise and What They Are

"It is lust only, Arjuna, which is born of contact with the material mode of passion and later transformed into anger — the all-devouring, sinful enemy of this world." —
Kṛṣṇa, Bhagavad-gītā 3.37

Part Two traces the chain that blocks the name — **Guṇas** → **Śaḍ-Ripu** → **Anarthas** → **Pāpa** → **Aparādha** → **Blocked Name**. This chapter covers the first two links together: *why* the soul is exposed to the modes at all, and *what* the six enemies born from them are.

4.1 Why the Soul Can Be Covered — the Taṭasthā Position

The living entity is **marginal energy** (taṭasthā-śakti) — minute (aṇu), conscious (cetana), eternal (sanātana), and Kṛṣṇa's part (amśa), able to associate with either the spiritual or the material energy (BG 7.4–5, 15.7).

mamaivāṁśo jīva-loke jīva-bhūtaḥ sanātanaḥ
manaḥ-śaṣṭhānīndriyāṇi prakṛti-sthāni karṣati (BG 15.7)

Because the soul is *minute*, it can be covered — as a spark can be put out though the sun cannot. The mechanism is **guṇa-saṅga**, association with the modes (BG 13.22), switched on by **false ego** (ahaṅkāra), which makes the soul think, "I am the doer, I am the enjoyer" (BG 3.27).

	Jīva	Kṛṣṇa
Size	aṇu (minute)	vibhu (infinite)
Coverable?	yes	never
Modes	influenced by	controller of

From the lectures. Sacinandana Swami Mahārāja locates the root of bondage in *aham-mama* — "I and mine" — the proprietary illusion that binds the soul; and Bhūrijana Prabhu opens from the jīva's constitutional position: we are eternal parts of Kṛṣṇa whose very nature is to serve, so misidentifying with matter is the original wound.

4.2 The Six Enemies (Ṣaḍ-Ripu)

From guṇa-saṅga arise the six inner enemies. BG 3.37 names *kāma* as the root; when frustrated it becomes *krodha*; the whole set are the "three gates to hell" and their kin (BG 16.21).

Enemy	Sanskrit	Root guṇa	Core move	First remedy
Kāma — lust	काम	rajas	craving to enjoy/possess	higher taste (Ch 15)
Krodha — anger	क्रोध	rajas→tamas	frustrated lust erupts	tolerance (Ch 11)
Lobha — greed	लोभ	rajas	never-enough acquiring	contentment (Ch 15)
Moha — illusion	मोह	tamas	forgets the real	knowledge (Ch 13)
Mada — pride	मद	rajas + tamas	intoxication with position	humility (Ch 10)
Mātsarya — envy	मात्सर्य	tamas + rajas	can't bear others' good	respect (Ch 12)

The chain within the chain (BG 2.62–63). Contemplating sense objects → attachment → lust → anger → delusion → loss of memory → loss of intelligence → ruin. Note the order: *krodha* is downstream of *kāma*. Treat the root (lust), not only the symptom (anger).

A parable — the six thieves in the heart

A king asks a sage why he has no peace despite owning everything. "You have welcomed six invisible thieves who live in your heart," the sage replies. "*Kāma* steals contentment; *krodha* burns your bridges; *lobha* clutches what you cannot keep; *moha* makes rope look like snake; *mada* makes you think you already know; *mātsarya* turns others' joy into your sorrow. Until you evict them, no wealth brings peace."

From the lectures. Sacinandana Swami Mahārāja treats *false ego* as the chanter's constant disturbing companion (Harināma Cintāmaṇi seminar 04); Vaiṣeṣika Prabhu traces suffering to "material intelligence" — the reflex of seeing every situation as something to enjoy or control, which yields the opposite of what it seeks ("Purify the Mind").

4.3 Why This Matters for Chanting

Each enemy, left active, breeds a specific offense (Chapter 7) and specifically curtains the name. Conditioning and liberation are mirror processes:

Conditioning	Liberation
desire to enjoy separately	desire to serve
"I am the enjoyer"	"I am the servant"
guṇa-saṅga	nāma-saṅga (association with the Name)

The name is **śuddha-sattva** — transcendental to all three modes — so associating with it directly weakens the guṇa-saṅga from which the enemies grow. This is why a sāttvika lifestyle (Chapter 15) *supports* japa, and why the name itself is the ultimate weapon against the six.

→ Next: the residue these enemies deposit in the heart — the anarthas.

Chapter 5 • Anartha — Unwanted Things (Root)

"As soon as irrevocable loving service is established in the heart, the effects of nature's modes of passion and ignorance — lust and greed — disappear from the heart. Then the devotee is established in goodness, and he becomes happy." — Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 1.2.19

An **anartha** is literally a "non-value" — an unwanted thing the enemies of Chapter 4 deposit in the heart. Anarthas are the *residue* of guṇa-saṅga: the enemies act, and what settles behind is a tendency, a taste, a weakness that persists even after the immediate impulse passes. They are the "root" in the chain because they are what make offenses (Chapter 7) feel natural rather than foreign.

5.1 The Four Kinds of Anartha (Bhajana-rahasya)

#	Anartha	Sanskrit	What it is
1	Illusion about truth	<i>tattva-vibhrama</i>	wrong ideas about the self, God, the world, and their relations
2	Thirst for the temporary	<i>asat-trṣṇā</i>	craving for material objects here and hereafter
3	Offenses	<i>aparādha</i>	offenses to the name, the deity, and devotees (Chapter 7)
4	Weakness of heart	<i>hṛdaya-daurbalya</i>	envy, deceit, hankering for prestige, fault-finding

The most corrosive for a chanter is the fourth. As Haridāsa Ṭhākura teaches, the daily enemy of japa is not gross sin but **pramāda** — inattention, restlessness, and the quiet indifference of "I don't really care anymore." That is *hṛdaya-daurbalya* wearing an ordinary face.

5.2 Why Anarthas Block the Name

The name is fully potent (Chapter 1); anarthas do not weaken *it* — they occupy the *space* where its taste would be felt. A cup already full of stale water has no room for nectar. This is why more rounds alone rarely help a blocked chanter: the work is not adding water pressure but **emptying the cup**.

From the lectures. Sacinandana Swami Mahārāja devotes whole sessions to *pramāda* — glossed as distractedness, restlessness, and "I just don't care any longer" — showing how this single anartha keeps chanting at the level of *nāmābhāsa* (Chapter 8). Vaiśeṣika Prabhu frames the same emptying as curing "material intelligence," the habit of viewing everything as an object to enjoy or control.

5.3 How Anarthas Clear

Anarthas do not leave by force of will; they dissolve through *sādhana* and, above all, through the name itself — the "universal solvent." The clearing (*anartha-nivṛtti*) proceeds in stages, which we map in Chapter 18. For now the practical point is diagnostic (Chapter 9): **name your dominant anartha**, because you cannot empty a cup you refuse to look into.

→ *Next: when anarthas are indulged, they ripen into overt sins — pāpa.*

Chapter 6 • Pāpa — Sins (Branch)

"...he gave him permission to reside in four places — where gambling, drinking, prostitution and slaughter of animals were performed." — Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 1.17.38 (Sūta Gosvāmī)

When anarthas (Chapter 5) are indulged, they branch outward into overt sinful acts — **pāpa**. In the chain of bondage, sins are the visible foliage: the part everyone sees, but downstream of the enemies and anarthas that produced them.

6.1 The Four Pillars of Irreligion (SB 1.17.38)

When Mahārāja Parīkṣit checked Kali, he confined him to four places. These became the four acts that dismantle spiritual life — each one destroying a specific pillar of *dharma*.

Sin	Sanskrit	Pillar of dharma destroyed	Root enemy
Gambling	द्यूतम्	<i>satyam</i> — truthfulness	lobha
Intoxication	पानम्	<i>tapah</i> — austerity	moha
Illicit sex	स्त्रियः	<i>śaucam</i> — cleanliness	kāma
Meat-eating	सूना	<i>dayā</i> — mercy	krodha

The logic is exact. Gambling makes a life of deception (kills truth). Intoxication removes all self-control (kills austerity). Illicit sex destroys inner and outer purity (kills cleanliness). Animal slaughter hardens the heart to violence (kills mercy). Where all four are avoided, **Kali has no residence** in that person's life.

6.2 Why the Four Principles Come First

The four regulative principles are not arbitrary rules; they are the removal of Kali's four seats. For the chanter they matter because **sin committed on the strength of the name is the seventh offense** (Chapter 7): "I will chant it off."

That single rationalization keeps a chanter perpetually blocked, feeding the very fire he is trying to extinguish.

6.3 The Name and the Sin

Here the mercy of Chapter 1 returns with a caution. The name destroys unlimited sins (SB 6.2.14) — *but* deliberately sinning in expectation of that mercy is an offense that blocks the mercy itself. The name freely forgives the sinner who is *struggling to stop*; it withholds its taste from the one who *plans* to sin and settle accounts by chanting. Avoiding the four pillars is therefore not pre-qualification for chanting — anyone may chant — but it is how a chanter stops re-clouding his own sun.

From the lectures. Bhūrijana Prabhu, on Ajāmila, shows the other side: even the man who *broke* all four principles was delivered when he called the name helplessly — because he was falling *toward* the Lord, not exploiting Him. The dividing line is the heart's direction.

→ *Next: the subtlest and most dangerous fruit of the chain — offenses to the name itself.*

Chapter 7 • Nāma-Aparādha — The Ten Offenses (Fruit)

"The name is always present, like the sun; it is our offenses that are the clouds hiding it from us." — HH Sacīnandana Swami Mahārāja (as taught, Holy-Name Retreat 2014, session 08)

Offenses (*nāma-aparādha*) are the **fruit** of the chain — the point at which the enemies and anarthas of the previous chapters directly touch the name and curtain its potency (*Mādhurya-kādambinī* 3.19, Chapter 3). This is the single most practical chapter in Part Two: name your offense and you have found the cloud.

7.1 The Ten Offenses to the Holy Name (Padma Purāṇa)

#	Offense	Root enemy	Direct remedy	Cure chapter
1	Blaspheming devotees	mātsarya	serve the offended devotee	Ch 12
2	Equating the Lord with demigods	moha	study tattva (BG 7.20)	Ch 13
3	Disregarding the guru	mada	increase submission & service	Ch 10
4	Blaspheming scripture	mada	hear submissively, with faith	Ch 10
5	Deeming the glories exaggeration	moha	re-read the transformed lives (Ch 2)	Ch 13
6	Concocting meanings of the name	mada	accept the paramparā	Ch 10
7	Sinching on the strength of the name	kāma	genuine repentance; stop	Ch 6, 14
8	Treating the name as ordinary piety	lobha	know its supremacy	Ch 13
9	Instructing the faithless	mada	assess the hearer first	Ch 10

#	Offense	Root enemy	Direct remedy	Cure chapter
10	Inattention; clinging to "I and mine"	kāma	develop taste; hear one mantra	Ch 14–15

The gravest is the first. Offense to a devotee (*vaiṣṇava-aparādha*) is the "mad elephant" that uproots the whole creeper of devotion in one stroke — even great power cannot survive it (Durvāsā fleeing the disc after offending Ambariṣa). This is why humility, tolerance, and respect (Chapters 10–12) are placed first among the cures.

7.2 The Sun and the Clouds

The governing image (from the epigraph) resolves the whole puzzle of Chapter 3. The name — the sun — is never diminished. Offenses are clouds: they do not touch the sun; they block *my* view of it. Therefore:

- The problem is never "add more sun" (chant more mechanically).
- The problem is always "clear the specific cloud" (name and remedy the offense).

One cleared cloud lets in more light than ten thousand rounds chanted through an overcast heart.

From the lectures. Sacīnandana Swami Mahārāja teaches that *studying* an offense is only half-finished work — the other half is learning to *overcome* it (Kirtan Course, sessions 14 & 16). He singles out the tenth offense — attachment to "I and mine" — as the one that most quietly leaves a person "unable to taste" (Kirtan Course 21).

7.3 From List to Diagnosis

This chapter gives the map; Chapter 9 turns it into a personal instrument — a **Ten-Offense Audit** in which each offense becomes an honest yes/no question about *my* chanting. The Kṛṣṇa-Dāsa dialogue of Chapter 3 was exactly that audit, spoken aloud.

→ Next: what all of this produces — the blocked name, and the three stages by which chanting rises.

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Chapter 8 • Nāmābhāsa — The Blocked Holy Name (Result)

Chanting matures through three stages — the offensive name, the shadow of the name (nāmābhāsa), and at last the pure name. — the teaching of Śrīla Haridāsa Ṭhākura, Harināma Cintāmaṇi (paraphrased)

The chain of Part Two ends here, at its **result**: the blocked name — chanting that touches the lips but not the heart. But "blocked" is not a dead end; it is a *stage on a road*. Understanding the three stages of chanting turns a discouraging diagnosis into a map with a clear direction of travel.

8.1 The Three Stages (Hari-nāma-cintāmaṇi)

Stage	Sanskrit	What it is	Felt reality
1	Nāmāparādha	offensive chanting	mind wanders; dryness; duty
2	Nāmābhāsa	the <i>shadow</i> of the name	flickers of taste; some sweetness
3	Śuddha-nāma	the <i>pure</i> name	steady taste; the name as a Person; prema

The movement is not automatic with quantity; it is unlocked by **clearing offenses** (Chapter 7) and by *quality* of attention. One does not chant one's way from Stage 1 to Stage 3 by speed — one clears clouds, and the same rounds begin to shine.

8.2 The Astonishing Power of the Shadow

Recall SB 6.2.14 (Chapter 2): even *nāmābhāsa* — the mere shadow — destroys unlimited sins and delivered Ajāmila. This is the great encouragement for the blocked chanter: **even your dim chanting is already working**. Like ultraviolet light through cloud, it acts whether or not you feel it. The task is not to manufacture feeling but to keep chanting while thinning the cloud.

8.3 The One Disqualification

There is a single posture that blocks even the subtle rays: the *Māyāvāda* idea that "I am becoming God by chanting." Offenseless chanting is sub-servient and prayerful — a helpless soul calling the Lord (Chapters 10–13). The moment chanting is turned into a technique for self-elevation-into-God, it inverts its own direction.

From the lectures. Sacinandana Swami Mahārāja maps the same ascent — from "shadow chanting" up into "the light of pure devotion" — again and again across the Kirtan Course (sessions 07 and 10): the name reveals itself by *its own mercy*, not by our technique; our part is attentive, humble persistence while the offenses lift.

8.4 The Hinge

Part Two has now shown the whole disease: **why** the enemies arise (Ch 4), the **residue** they leave (Ch 5), the **sins** they branch into (Ch 6), the **offenses** that curtain the name (Ch 7), and the **blocked chanting** that results (Ch 8). The general anatomy is complete.

But a disease described is not a patient diagnosed. The next chapter turns all of this inward: not "here is the chain" but "**here is exactly where the chain binds me, and what to do today.**"

→ Next: Chapter 9 — *Nāma-Roga-Nirṇaya*, diagnosing my personal blockage.

Chapter 9 • नाम-रोग-निर्णय • NĀMA-ROGA-NIRṆAYA

Diagnosing My Personal Blockage

"Be determined to hear one mantra. Just one mantra." — HG Bhūrijana Prabhu
(Japa Seminar, Day 03)

9.1 The Diagnostic Principle

Chapters 4–8 laid out the whole disease — the chain that runs **Guṇas** → **Ṣaḍ-Ripu** → **Anarthas** → **Pāpa** → **Aparādha** → **Blocked Name**. But a chain is general; a patient is particular. The purpose of this chapter is to move from "chanting is blocked" to "here is exactly where *my* chanting is blocked, and here is what to do about it today."

The governing image is Sacīnandana Swami Mahārāja's: **the holy name is always present, like the sun; it is our own offenses that are the clouds hiding it**. The sun never fails. So when I feel nothing, the honest question is never "Why doesn't the Name work?" but "**Which cloud is over my sun right now?**"

How this differs from Chapter 3. Chapter 3 told one devotee's story (Kṛṣṇa Dāsa) so I could recognize myself in it. This chapter hands me the instruments to examine *myself* — a self-diagnosis I run on my own japa, not a narrative I read about someone else.

The Mādhurya-kādambinī gives the clinical basis (the teaching rendered in Sanskrit):

bhagavan-nāmni saṁprāpte 'parādhe sati tat-prabhāvaṁ na darśayati — "When an offense is present, the holy name does not reveal its full potency to the offender."

The Name withholds nothing; the *offender's perception* is what is curtailed. Diagnosis, then, is simply learning to read my own curtain.

9.2 Symptom → Cause Map

The fastest diagnostic is to notice **what my mind actually does during japa**, and trace it back. Each surface symptom points to an active enemy (Chapter 4), which breeds a specific offense (Chapter 7), which has a specific cure (Part Three).

What I experience during japa	Active enemy	Offense it breeds	Turn to
Planning pleasures, daydreaming, "what's next"	Kāma (lust)	#7 (sinning on the Name's strength), #10 (attachment)	Ch 14 + Ch 15
Replaying an argument; rehearsing a reply; irritation	Krodha (anger)	#1 (offense to a devotee)	Ch 11 + Ch 14
Rushing, watching the clock, "just finish the rounds"	Lobha (greed)	#8 (Name as a means to a result)	Ch 13
"Is this doing anything?"; doubt; forgetting the teaching	Moha (illusion)	#5 (Name's glory is exaggeration), #6 (concocting)	Ch 2 (re-read the lives), Ch 13
"I chant better than them"; comparing favorably	Mada (pride)	#3 (disrespect to guru/senior), #9 (instructing the faithless)	Ch 10
Mentally criticizing a devotee; envy at another's advancement	Mātsarya (envy)	#1 (offense to a devotee)	Ch 12

Read your tone, not just your thoughts. As taught in the *Sonicate Your Life* seminar, the *tone* of chanting reveals the heart. If the inner voice of my japa is bored, resentful, or transactional, that tone is itself the diagnostic reading.

9.3 The Three Instruments

Run all three once for a full picture; thereafter, the one-minute Symptom Map above is usually enough for daily practice.

Instrument A — Śaḍ-Ripu Self-Assessment (*which enemy dominates me?*)

Score each line 0 (never), 1 (sometimes), 2 (often) for *this past week*.

#	Statement	Enemy	Score
1	My attention drifts to things I want to enjoy or acquire	Kāma	☐
2	I replayed conflicts or felt the urge to retaliate	Krodha	☐
3	I chanted fast, anxious mainly to be done	Lobha	☐
4	I doubted whether chanting really changes anything	Moha	☐
5	I felt superior to other devotees or to newcomers	Mada	☐
6	I found fault with a devotee, silently or aloud	Mātsarya	☐

My dominant enemy = the line(s) scoring highest. That is the enemy to name in today's japa and the chapter to study first. (Ties are common; treat the two together.)

Instrument B — Ten-Offense Audit (*what am I actually doing?*)

A yes/no self-check. Honesty here is the whole value — this is the Kṛṣṇa-Dāsa dialogue of Chapter 3 turned inward.

#	Nāma-aparādha	Honest answer
1	Do I criticize or belittle devotees (even mentally)?	☐ Y ☐ N
2	Do I equate Kṛṣṇa/the Name with the demigods?	☐ Y ☐ N
3	Do I disregard my guru's or seniors' instructions?	☐ Y ☐ N
4	Do I disparage scripture?	☐ Y ☐ N
5	Do I secretly think the Name's glories are exaggerated?	☐ Y ☐ N
6	Do I impose my own concocted meanings on the Name?	☐ Y ☐ N
7	Do I sin on the strength of "I'll just chant it off"?	☐ Y ☐ N
8	Do I treat chanting as one pious ritual among many?	☐ Y ☐ N
9	Do I instruct the faithless who don't want to hear?	☐ Y ☐ N
10	Do I chant inattentively, clinging to "I and mine"?	☐ Y ☐ N

Every **Y** is a named cloud. Offenses #1, #3, #9 trace to **mada/mātsarya** (→ Ch 10, 12); #5, #6 to **moha** (→ Ch 13); #7, #10 to **kāma** (→ Ch 14–15); #8 to **lobha** (→ Ch 13).

Instrument C — Anartha-Stage Locator (*how far along am I?*)

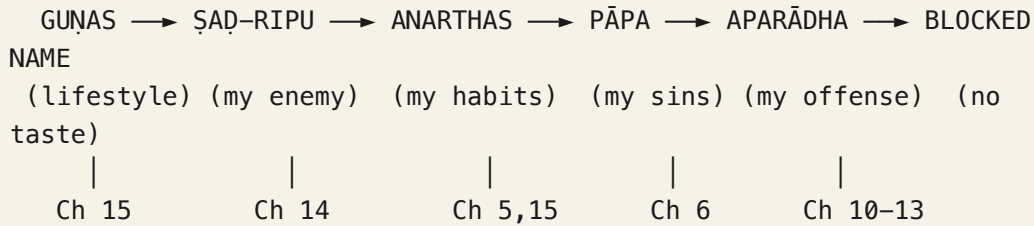
Following Mādhurya-kādambinī's four stages of *anartha-nivṛtti* (clearing), locate the honest present stage — not to grade myself, but to set realistic expectations and avoid discouragement.

Stage	Sanskrit	Felt reality
1	Eka-deśa-vartinī (~¼)	A few bad habits loosening; occasional clarity in japa
2	Bahu-deśa-vartinī (~½)	Noticeable behavior change; regular periods of peace
3	Prāyikī (~¾)	Others notice the change; steadiness under pressure
4	Pūrṇā (complete)	Anarthas gone; unshakeable absorption

Most sincere practitioners live between Stage 1 and 2 for years. *That is normal, not failure* — Bhūrijana Prabhu's counsel applies: the task is never "sixteen perfect rounds," only **this one mantra, heard**.

9.4 The Chain Locator

Plot the findings on the chain. Circle where the blockage *originates* — treating a downstream link while the upstream one runs is why chanting "doesn't work."



- If my enemies flare mainly when I'm **tired, rushed, or overstimulated** → the origin is upstream at **Guṇas**; begin at **Ch 15 (lifestyle)**.
- If lifestyle is steady but one **enemy still dominates** → begin at **Ch 14**, plus the specific quality-chapter (Ch 10 humility / 11 tolerance / 12 respect).
- If the enemies are quiet but an **offense persists** (an unresolved Y in Instrument B) → go straight to the **remedy for that offense** and, where it involves a person, **make amends first**.

9.5 My Personal Prescription

Fill this in after running the instruments. Keep it to **one** primary target — trying to fix everything at once is itself a form of *lobha*.

PERSONAL PRESCRIPTION	Date: _____
Dominant enemy (Instr. A) : _____	
Active offense (Instr. B) : _____	
Anartha stage (Instr. C) : _____	
Origin on the chain (9.4) : _____	
→ PRIMARY CHAPTER TO WORK : Ch ____ (_____)	
→ ONE PART-FIVE CARD TO USE : _____	
→ TODAY'S PRE-MANTRA VOW : "I will hear THIS one mantra, and when _____ (my enemy) arises, I will _____ (the counter)."	

This is the practical fusion of two teachers' methods: Mahātmā Prabhu's "*worst-enemy assessment*" (name the one enemy before you begin) and Sacīnandana Swami Mahārāja's "*two doors*" (before each mantra, consciously choose to chant *with love* rather than mechanically).

9.6 The Re-Diagnosis Cadence

A diagnosis is not a verdict; it is a reading that changes. The heart is a moving target — "we are not even the same person the next morning." So:

- **Daily (30 sec):** the Symptom Map (9.2) — name today's cloud before the first round.
- **Monthly (10 min):** re-run all three Instruments; compare with last month's Prescription.
- **After any fall or dry spell:** run Instrument B first — a persistent offense, not a weak Name, is almost always the cause.

The goal is not a clean scorecard. It is the shift Chapter 3 could only describe and this chapter makes operational: **"The Name didn't change. I changed — by naming and clearing the one cloud in front of my sun."**

→ *Continue to Part Three (Ch 10, Humility) — the first and most important cure, since pride is the root from which most clouds form.*

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Chapter 10 • Vinaya — Humility (Tṛṇād Api Sunīcena)

"One should chant the holy name in a humble state of mind, thinking oneself lower than the straw in the street." — Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu, Śikṣāṣṭaka 3

Part Three is the cure. It opens with humility because **pride (mada) is the root from which most clouds form** (offenses #3, #4, #6, #9 all trace to it), and because Śrī Caitanya names humility first among the qualifications for constant chanting.

10.1 The Verse

tṛṇād api sunīcena taror api sahiṣṇunā
amāninā mānadena kīrtanīyaḥ sadā hariḥ (Śikṣāṣṭaka 3)

"Thinking oneself lower than the straw in the street, more tolerant than a tree, free of false prestige, and ready to offer all respect to others — in that state one should chant the name of Hari constantly."

The verse is not decorative; it is *prescriptive*. It names the inner posture in which the name actually acts. This chapter takes the first quality (*tṛṇād api sunīcena*); Chapters 11 and 12 take the next two.

10.2 "Lower Than the Straw"

Property of straw	Humble chanter
stepped on by all	accepts the lowest place
never protests	demands no recognition
expects nothing	wants no honor
rises after being crushed	recovers from insult

Three depths of humility: **external** (courteous behavior), **mental** (no felt superiority), and **spiritual** (seeing oneself as utterly dependent on Kṛṣṇa's mercy — *akiñcana*, having nothing of one's own). The *su* in *sunīcena* means "very": ordinary politeness is not enough; the realization is "without Kṛṣṇa's mercy I am nothing."

10.3 How Humility Clears Offenses

Offense from pride	Humility's answer
#1 criticizing devotees	"they are more advanced than I"
#3 disregarding guru	"I am nothing without his mercy"
#6 concocting meanings	"let me accept the paramparā"
#9 instructing the faithless	"am I qualified to teach anyone?"

The straw and the storm

In a gale the proud oak declared, "I will not bend" — and cracked. The blade of grass bent flat and, when the storm passed, simply stood back up. Bending before a greater force is not defeat but intelligence. *Tṛṇād api sunīcena* is spiritual survival.

10.4 Practice

- **Morning (3 min):** recite *tṛṇād api sunīcena*; resolve to be servant of all today.
- **Under praise:** "this belongs to Kṛṣṇa; I am an instrument."
- **Under criticism:** first ask, "is there truth here to learn?"; then, "can I tolerate the rest?"
- **Evening (2 min):** where did I feel superior, compete for recognition, or resist correction?

From the lectures. Sacīnandana Swami Mahārāja frames the whole retreat's aim as recovering the "vertical," prayerful posture — the holy name becomes real only when the chanter turns to Kṛṣṇa in humble, helpless prayer ("Chanting with Humility," "Chanting Prayerfully").

→ Next: the second quality — tolerance, more forbearing than a tree.

Chapter 11 · Sahiṣṇutā — Tolerance (Taror Api Sahiṣṇunā)

A devotee should be more tolerant than a tree — which never protests even when cut down, and offers its shade to everyone. — Śrīla Prabhupāda (gloss on Śikṣāṣṭaka 3, paraphrased)

The second quality of Śikṣāṣṭaka 3 directly counteracts **krodha** (anger) — the enemy that does the most damage in the fewest seconds, and the one most likely to produce the gravest offense (blaspheming a devotee, #1).

11.1 "More Tolerant Than a Tree"

What a tree endures	What a devotee endures
cut down — gives wood	insulted — gives blessings
scorched — gives shade	persecuted — gives shelter
stoned — drops fruit	harmed — offers service

Tolerance here is not suppression; it is **strength** — the settled knowledge that Kṛṣṇa is the controller, so an insult is His arrangement for my purification, not an emergency requiring retaliation.

11.2 Prahlāda's Example (SB 7.9.43)

Thrown from cliffs, given poison, cast into fire, trampled by elephants — Prahlāda never grew angry. His tolerance flowed from **absorption**: *tvad-vīrya-gāyana-mahāmṛta-magna-cittaḥ*, "my mind is merged in the great nectar of Your glories." The deepest tolerance is a by-product of being full; there is no room for anger in a heart already occupied by the name.

11.3 The P.A.U.S.E. Method

When provoked (10–30 seconds):

Step	Action	Inner words
P	Pause	"Stop — don't react."
A	Acknowledge	"I am feeling anger."
U	Understand	"What desire of mine was frustrated?"
S	Surrender	"Kṛṣṇa, please help me respond."
E	Engage wisely	respond, don't react

Because *krodha* is downstream of *kāma* (BG 2.62–63), the durable cure treats the frustrated desire beneath the anger, not just the flare.

11.4 Practice

- **Morning vow:** "Whatever comes today, I will respond, not react; I will see difficulty as mercy."
- **In traffic / delay:** "Thank you, Kṛṣṇa, for this patience practice" — chant during the wait.
- **Evening:** list any anger episodes; trace each to the desire beneath it; offer it to Kṛṣṇa.

The jackfruit tree

Children threw stones to knock down its fruit — it dropped more. Travelers carved their names — it grew more shade. A limb was cut — new branches sprouted from the wound. "That tree," an old farmer said, "taught me more of spiritual life than all my years in the temple. It only gives; it never retaliates."

→ Next: the third quality — offering respect while expecting none.

Chapter 12 • Māna-Dāna — Respect (Amāninā Mānadena)

"amāninā mānadena" — "expecting no honor for oneself, yet ready to offer all respect to others." — Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu, Śikṣāṣṭaka 3

The third quality of Śikṣāṣṭaka 3 is a two-edged formula that dismantles mātsarya (envy) at its root:

Term	Sanskrit	Meaning
amāninā	अमानिना	expecting no respect for oneself
mānadena	मानदेन	actively offering respect to others

It is not enough to *not* want honor (*amānina*); one must *give* honor (*mānada*). The living being naturally craves respect — a perverted reflection of its true position as Kṛṣṇa's servant. By *giving* honor, I satisfy that craving in others and drain the envy from my own heart.

12.1 Respect vs. Envy

Situation	Respect (mānadena)	Envy (mātsarya)
others succeed	"wonderful — how can I help?"	"why them, not me?"
others are praised	"they deserve it"	"but what about <i>my</i> work?"
others are served	"they deserve even more"	"I should be served too"
effect on chanting	a peaceful mind	a disturbed mind

Envy is the subtlest enemy because it disguises itself as discernment ("I'm just being honest about their faults"). It is also the most dangerous, because it produces the first and gravest offense — blaspheming a devotee (Chapter 7).

12.2 The Vaiṣṇava Vision

A devotee offers respect because he sees **Kṛṣṇa in every heart** (SB 3.29). Even at a beginner's stage one can *practice* this vision: "everyone I meet has Kṛṣṇa within; I will find something to honor in each." Every act of respect thereby becomes worship.

12.3 Practice

- **Daily:** sincerely appreciate one devotee — verbally if possible.
- **Transform envy on the spot:** when it rises, pray, "Kṛṣṇa, give me *that* devotee's good quality" — turning envy into *spṛhā*, holy aspiration.
- **Give credit freely, take blame willingly.**
- **Evening:** did I mentally criticize anyone? feel superior? offer respect actively?

From the lectures. The three qualities of Śikṣāṣṭaka 3 — humility, tolerance, respect — recur as the through-line of Sacīnandana Swami Mahārāja's teaching on prayerful chanting: the name comes alive only in a heart that has stopped competing for its own honor.

→ *Next: putting these qualities to work in the act itself — offense-free chanting.*

Chapter 13 • Niraparādha — Offense-Free Chanting

"Chant attentively, chant with quality, and pray for mercy — each grows out of the last." — HH Sacīnandana Swami Mahārāja (as taught, Kirtan Course, Day 03)

Chapters 10–12 built the *inner posture* (humility, tolerance, respect). This chapter applies it to the *act*: chanting that steadily clears the ten offenses (Chapter 7) and carries chanting from *nāmāparādha* toward *śuddha-nāma* (Chapter 8).

13.1 The Ten Remedies at a Glance

#	Offense	Remedy
1	blaspheming devotees	serve them; find their good qualities
2	Lord = demigods	study tattva (BG 7.20)
3	disregarding guru	increase submission and service
4	blaspheming scripture	hear submissively, with faith
5	glories = exaggeration	re-read the transformed lives (Ch 2)
6	concocting meanings	accept the paramparā
7	sinning on the name's strength	genuine repentance; actually stop
8	name = ordinary piety	meditate on its supremacy
9	instructing the faithless	assess the hearer first
10	inattention; "I and mine"	develop taste; hear <i>one</i> mantra

13.2 The Three-Fold Discipline

Sacīnandana Swami Mahārāja's epigraph gives the working sequence, each stage growing from the last:

1. **Attentively** — hear the mantra; do not let it become background sound.

2. **With quality** — add the "one drop of sincerity"; it is not only the mantra but the *mood* of the chanter that counts (a mother knows her child's true cry from its ordinary sounds).
3. **Praying for mercy** — chant as a helpless soul calling the Lord, not as a technician producing a result. The name reveals itself by *its own* mercy; our part is the sincere call.

13.3 From Shadow to Substance

Bhaktivinoda Ṭhākura's prescription for moving from *nāmāparādha* to *nāmābhāsa* and onward:

Step	Action
1	identify which offenses are active (Chapter 9)
2	apply the specific remedy for each
3	increase association with pure devotees
4	chant more <i>attentively</i> — quality over quantity
5	hear about the name's glories to rebuild faith
6	be patient — transformation takes time

From the lectures. Sacinandana Swami Mahārāja teaches faith as the *entry* into offenseless chanting (Harinaam Cintamani 01) and attentive chanting as the *fountainhead* from which all further results flow (Harinaam Cintamani 05). Bhūrijana Prabhu ranks offenseless, attentive chanting above liberation, yoga, and solitary forest meditation ("Japa Retreat, afternoon").

→ *Next: when the enemies attack mid-japa — practical, in-the-moment control.*

Chapter 14 • Damah — Practical Control of the Six Enemies

"Bring your mind back to the mantra itself." — HG Vaiśeṣika Prabhu (Japa Workshop)

Chapters 10–13 built posture and offense-free habit. This chapter is tactical: what to *do* when a specific enemy attacks in the middle of a round.

14.1 The Samādhāya Method (SB 8.3.1)

When Gajendra was seized by the crocodile, Śukadeva describes exactly how he chanted:

evam vyavasito buddhyā samādhāya mano hṛdi
jajāpa paramaṁ jāpyaṁ prāg-jaṇmany anuśikṣitam (SB 8.3.1)

Word	Application
<i>vyavasitaḥ</i> — determined	"I will chant with attention <i>now</i> ."
<i>buddhyā</i> — by intelligence	"Which enemy is disturbing me?"
<i>samādhāya</i> — concentrating	gather the scattered mind
<i>mano hṛdi</i> — mind in the heart	chant from the heart, not the head

14.2 Enemy-Specific Japa Strategies

Enemy	Sign during japa	On-the-spot counter
Kāma	planning pleasures	"all pleasure is from Kṛṣṇa"
Krodha	replaying a conflict	"the tree gives wood when cut"
Lobha	rushing, clock-watching	deliberately slow down
Moha	"is this doing anything?"	"one Name saved Ajāmila"
Mada	"I chant better than them"	"lower than the straw"

Enemy	Sign during japa	On-the-spot counter
Mātsarya	criticizing a devotee	find three of their good qualities

14.3 Emergency Protocol (under 30 seconds)

Step	Action
1 Recognize	"This is anger / greed / pride."
2 Stop	pause the beads a moment
3 Breathe	three slow breaths
4 Pray	"Kṛṣṇa, please help me."
5 Reframe	apply the specific counter above
6 Resume	continue with renewed attention
7 Note	remember it for the evening review

The measure of success is **the return of attention, not the absence of distraction**. The mind will wander a hundred times; bring it back a hundred and one. As Vaiṣeṣika Prabhu puts it, the chanter's whole job is to keep *bringing the mind back to the mantra itself* — Kṛṣṇa supplies the attraction.

From the lectures. Across his japa workshops Vaiṣeṣika Prabhu trains this single reflex — chant, notice the wandering, return — and grounds it in *sonic theology*: the sound is non-different from Kṛṣṇa, so attentive hearing is contact with Him. Sacīnandana Swami Mahārāja reframes the same work from *mind-control* to *mind-absorption* ("Chanting with Absorption"): a mind wholly present is not fatigued but enlivened.

→ Next: *preparing the ground so the enemies arise weaker — lifestyle and taste.*

Chapter 15 • Guṇa-Tattva — Lifestyle & Nāma-Ruci

One who cannot rise early in the morning is not yet very serious about spiritual life — the brāhma-muhūrta is the time for chanting. — Śrīla Prabhupāda (paraphrased)

The enemies (Chapter 4) are born from the **modes** (guṇas). So the most upstream cure is to arrange one's life to weaken the modes that feed them. This chapter addresses the *root* of the chain: a sāttvika lifestyle does not itself grant prema — the name does that — but it clears the ground so the name can act.

15.1 How the Modes Shape Japa

sattvaṁ rajas tama iti guṇāḥ prakṛti-sambhavāḥ (BG 14.5)

Mode	Consciousness	Effect on hearing the Name
Sattva	clear, peaceful, alert	the name penetrates easily
Rajas	restless, distracted	heard but not absorbed
Tamas	dull, sleepy, foggy	the name bounces off

The enemies map onto the modes: kāma, krodha, lobha, mada from **rajas**; moha, mātsarya from **tamas**. Reduce tamas and rajas, and the enemies arise *weaker* before japa even begins.

15.2 The Four Levers

Lever	Sāttvika practice
Food (āhāra)	prasādam; fresh, light, timely; a light early dinner
Sleep (nidrā)	early to bed; rise in <i>brāhma-muhūrta</i> (~1.5 hr before sunrise)
Association (saṅga)	devotees, śāstra, kīrtana; guard what enters the ears before sleep
Environment	clean, quiet, phone away

Brāhma-muhūrta works because sattva predominates, the world is still, and the mind is naturally settled — the best rounds of the day are available to whoever will rise for them.

15.3 Taste (Nāma-Ruci) — the Real Goal

Lifestyle is the platform; **taste** is the aim. Taste for the name is *acquired*, like a jaundiced tongue relearning sweetness: the medicine tastes bitter before it cures, so one chants steadily, trusting the taste will come.

mām ca yo 'vyabhicāreṇa bhakti-yogena sevate
sa guṇān samatītyaitān brahma-bhūyāya kalpate (BG 14.26)

Unfailing devotional service *transcends* all three modes. Sattva is the runway; bhakti is the flight.

From the lectures. Vaiśeṣika Prabhu makes taste the organizing priority of life — "one who gets the taste needs nothing else" ("Get the Taste") — and pairs it with *rigid vow-keeping*: chant the fixed number every day without fail ("Keep Your Vow," "Don't Fade Away"). Sacinandana Swami Mahārāja adds the sustaining discipline of *taking the retreat home* — translating peak experience into daily life rather than letting it fade.

→ *Next: the whole practice distilled into portable tools — the japa cards.*

Chapter 16 • Japa — Quick-Reference Cards

"Call to Him — Kṛṣṇa, Kṛṣṇa — and hear the mantra." — HG Bhūrijana Prabhu
(Japa Retreat)

Everything in Part Three condenses here into **portable tools** — cards to keep by the japa seat. This chapter is the field manual; the full seventeen cards are printed in Appendix reference form. Below is the core set and how to use them.

16.1 The Four Foundation Cards

Card 1 — Three-Step Meditation (*Sacīnandana Swami Mahārāja*): before japa, establish (1) *who I am* — "I am a part of Kṛṣṇa, His eternal servant"; (2) *who Kṛṣṇa is* — "my only master"; (3) *the purpose of this world* — to reform my forgetfulness. Then set the intention: "*I am not chanting to finish rounds; I am calling out — please accept me.*"

Card 2 — The Two Doors (*Sacīnandana Swami Mahārāja*): before each mantra, choose. **Door 1 — mechanical:** pronunciation only, "finishing rounds." **Door 2 — with love:** calling to Kṛṣṇa. Door 1 frees from hell; **Door 2 draws Kṛṣṇa's notice.** Consciously choose Door 2.

Card 3 — Bhūrijana Prabhu's 4-Step Method:

Step	Practice
1 Saṅkalpa	"I will hear just <i>this one</i> mantra." (a request the mind can obey)
2 Neglect the mind	when it rebels, ignore it — like a stern parent with a whining child
3 Take shelter	the Name is Kṛṣṇa; take shelter in the sound
4 Await mercy	mercy is <i>received</i> , not achieved — chant attentively and wait

Card 4 — Pre-Japa Checklist: body settled, phone away, obeisances offered, one clear saṅkalpa, heart forgiven of anyone, mood of *servant* not *demanding controller*.

16.2 The Deeper Preparation

Card 5 — Govardhana Pañca-Bhūta Śuddhi (15 min): a five-element settling of body and breath — earth (grounding), water (flowing movement), fire (bhastrikā), air (nāḍī-śodhana), ether (three saṅkalpas) — so that, per SB 8.3.1, the mind can rest *in the heart* before the first bead.

16.3 Troubleshooting (quick fixes)

Problem	Fix
mind won't focus	chant louder, slower; hear each syllable
sleepy	stand, walk, wash the face, chant aloud
racing thoughts	note them on paper; return to the Name
mechanical/dry	add the prayer: "please reveal Yourself"
rushing	set 7–8 min per round; slow the first round deliberately

Golden rule: when the mind wanders, do not fight — gently *return*.

From the lectures. These cards are distilled from the corpus itself — Sacīnandana Swami Mahārāja's guided-japa sessions on *intention/saṅkalpa as the heart of chanting*, his "two doors," and Bhūrijana Prabhu's "one mantra" method. The whole of Part Three lives, finally, in a single instruction the beads can carry: *call to Him, and hear*.

→ *Part Four: what all of this produces — freedom, and finally, love.*

Chapter 17 • Jitendriya — Six Enemies Controlled

"A person free from all attachment and aversion, able to control the senses, obtains the complete mercy of the Lord." — Kṛṣṇa, Bhagavad-gītā 2.64

Part Four is the result — the chain of Part Two run in reverse as freedom is won. It begins where the problem began: the six enemies (Chapter 4). Controlled, they do not vanish from view; they lose their *grip*.

17.1 Transformation, Not Suppression

The cure does not delete the enemies — it *redirects* their energy toward Kṛṣṇa.

Enemy	Before	After (transformed)	Sign
Kāma	consuming material desire	desire to serve Kṛṣṇa	enthusiasm for service
Krodha	destructive anger	righteous energy only	patience under provocation
Lobha	material greed	spiritual eagerness	contentment; generosity
Moha	illusion	clarity	quick, śāstra-aligned decisions
Mada	false pride	genuine humility	comfort in the lowest place
Mātsarya	envy	holy aspiration (<i>spṛhā</i>)	joy at others' success

17.2 The Mark of Control

BG 2.64 names the state: moving through the world's sense-objects *without* being pulled by attraction or driven by aversion. This is not withdrawal from life but **freedom within it** — the senses engaged in Kṛṣṇa's service rather than commanded by the six thieves. The one who reaches it "obtains the complete mercy of the Lord" (*prasādam adhigacchati*), and in that mercy the higher results of Part Four unfold of themselves.

From the lectures. Mahātmā Prabhu's "worst-enemy assessment" and Sacīnandana Swami Mahārāja's shift from mind-control to mind-*absorption* both point here: the enemies are subdued not by wrestling them down but by filling the heart so full of the Name that they find no room.

→ *Next: with the enemies controlled, their residue dissolves — the anarthas destroyed.*

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Chapter 18 • Anartha-Nivṛtti — Anarthas Destroyed

Clearing of the unwanted (anartha-nivṛtti) comes in four degrees — partial, fuller, nearly complete, and complete. — Śrīla Viśvanātha Cakravartī Ṭhākura, Mādhurya-kādambinī (paraphrased)

As the enemies lose their grip (Chapter 17), the residue they deposited — the anarthas (Chapter 5) — begins to dissolve. This clearing (*anartha-nivṛtti*) is gradual, and knowing its stages protects the practitioner from both impatience and discouragement.

18.1 The Four Stages

Stage	Sanskrit	Extent	Felt reality
1	<i>eka-deśa-vartinī</i>	~¼	a few habits loosening; occasional clarity
2	<i>bahu-deśa-vartinī</i>	~½	visible behavior change; regular peace
3	<i>prāyikī</i>	~¾	others notice; steadiness under pressure
4	<i>pūrṇā</i>	complete	anarthas gone; unshakeable absorption

Most sincere practitioners live for years between Stages 1 and 2. **This is normal, not failure.** The cup empties one measure at a time.

18.2 Signs of Progress

Stage	External	Internal
1	some bad habits reducing	occasional clarity in japa
2	noticeable change	regular peace of mind
3	others comment on the change	deep steadiness
4	complete transformation	unshakeable devotion

18.3 The Agent of Clearing

Anarthas do not leave by force of will; they are dissolved by the name — the "universal solvent" — and by hearing, which Prabhupāda compares to food digesting automatically once eaten. The practitioner's only task is to keep taking the medicine (attentive hearing and chanting, Chapters 13–16); the digestion is Kṛṣṇa's.

From the lectures. Sacīnandana Swami Mahārāja frames the whole of progress as this emptying — shedding the false "I and mine" and awakening into *sambandha*, the living knowledge that "I am an eternal part of Kṛṣṇa, my only master." As that knowledge deepens, the unwanted simply has less to hold on to.

→ *Next: with the heart clearing, even the record of past sin is destroyed.*

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Chapter 19 • Agha-Kṣaya — Sins Destroyed

"Ajāmila has already atoned for the sins of millions of births, because in a helpless state he chanted the holy name of Nārāyaṇa." — Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 6.2.7 (the Viṣṇudūtas)

As the anarthas dissolve (Chapter 18), the pāpa they branched into (Chapter 6) is burned away. Here the name's power from Chapter 1 pays its full dividend: the destruction not of this life's sins alone, but of the accumulated karma of countless lifetimes.

19.1 The Reach of the Name

ayaṁ hi kṛta-nirveśo janma-koṭy-aṁhasām api
yad vyājahāra vivaśo nāma svasty-ayanaṁ hareḥ (SB 6.2.7)

"He has atoned for the sins of *millions of births* (*janma-koṭi*), because helplessly he uttered the all-auspicious name of Hari."

Note *janma-koṭi* — not the errors of one lifetime, but the debt of millions. And note *vivaśaḥ* — "helplessly": Ajāmila's chanting was barely even intentional, and still the reservoir emptied. This is the outer limit of the mercy established in Chapter 2.

19.2 Why It Is Not License

The very next verses (and Chapter 6 here) guard against the misreading: *deliberately* sinning in expectation of this cleansing is the seventh offense, which blocks the cleansing itself. The name runs to the sinner who is *falling toward* the Lord (Ajāmila), not to the one *calculating* on Him. The heart's direction is everything.

19.3 The Cleansing Is Real and Perceptible

Purification by the name is not a legal fiction but an experienced fact — the "becoming unstuck" Prabhupāda describes, as long-cherished material desires diminish "step by step." What jñāna and yoga can only settle temporarily (like mud sinking in still water, stirred up again by the least agitation), devotional hearing dissolves at the root, because the cleanser is the Lord Himself, present in His name.

From the lectures. Bhūrijana Prabhu builds his Ajāmila seminar to exactly this point: the name is the supreme atonement — and, beyond mere absolution, the means of capturing the Lord's attention and love. Erasing sin is only the doorway; what waits beyond it is the subject of the last two chapters.

→ *Next: past the sins lie the subtler offenses — and their forgiveness.*

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Chapter 20 • Kṣamā — Offenses Forgiven

"Abandon all varieties of religion and just surrender unto Me. I shall deliver you from all sinful reactions. Do not fear." — Kṛṣṇa, Bhagavad-gītā 18.66

Sins are one thing; **offenses to the name** (Chapter 7) are subtler and more obstinate — they are the last clouds to lift. This chapter is about their forgiveness, and it is the tenderest turn in the whole book, because it answers the fear left by Chapter 3: *"After all my offenses, is it too late for me?"* Kṛṣṇa's own answer is *mā śucaḥ* — "do not fear."

20.1 How Offenses Are Forgiven

Offense	How it clears	Timeline
to a devotee	serve and satisfy the offended one	until they are pleased
to the guru	deepen submission and service	by the guru's mercy
to scripture	study with faith and humility	gradual
to the name itself	keep chanting despite feeling unworthy	by the name's own mercy

20.2 Seven Steps to Forgiveness

Step	Inner movement
1 Recognize	"I committed this offense."
2 Feel remorse	genuine regret (not mere fear of consequence)
3 Confess	to a senior devotee, where appropriate
4 Apologize	sincerely, to the one offended
5 Resolve	"I will not repeat this."
6 Serve	render specific service to the offended party
7 Chant	with renewed attention and humility

20.3 The Ground of All Forgiveness

BG 18.66 is Kṛṣṇa's personal promise: to one who fully surrenders, even offenses are dissolved by His mercy — not by the offender's merit. Surrender is not a technique that *earns* forgiveness; it is the open hand into which forgiveness is placed. The name that seemed silent for fifteen years (Chapter 3) was never withholding forgiveness — only waiting for the heart to turn toward it.

From the lectures. Sacīnandana Swami Mahārāja teaches this at Surabhi Kuṇḍa — the very place where Indra, after grievously offending Vraja, was forgiven — showing that forgiveness of offenses is precisely what allows the holy name to at last bring Kṛṣṇa near.

→ *Next, and last: with every cloud gone, the sun stands revealed — Kṛṣṇa-prema.*

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Chapter 21 • Kṛṣṇa-Prema Attained

"Kṛṣṇa consciousness... can be attained only by paying one price — intense greed (*laulyam*) to obtain it." — Śrīla Rūpa Gosvāmī (*Padyāvalī* 14; quoted at Cc. Madhya 8.70)

Every cloud has now lifted — enemies controlled (17), anarthas destroyed (18), sins burned (19), offenses forgiven (20). What remains is not an achievement but a *revelation*: the sun that was never absent, now standing clear. This is **prema**, pure love of God — the goal (*prayojana*) toward which the entire book has been the road.

21.1 The One Price

kṛṣṇa-bhakti-rasa-bhāvitā matiḥ
kriyatām yadi kuto 'pi labhyate
tatra laulyam api mūlyam ekalaṁ
janma-koṭi-sukṛtair na labhyate (Rūpa Gosvāmī, *Padyāvalī* 14; Cc. Madhya 8.70)

Prema cannot be bought by pious deeds of even millions of births. It has exactly one price: *laulyam* — an intense, aching greed for it. This is the great equalizer. Every chapter's discipline matters, but none of it *purchases* prema; it only clears the way for the one currency that does — a heart that truly wants Kṛṣṇa.

21.2 The Nine Steps of the Creeper (bhakti-latā)

Prema is the ripe fruit of a creeper grown through nine stages (Rūpa Gosvāmī):

śraddhā → sādhu-saṅga → bhajana-kriyā → anartha-nivṛtti → niṣṭhā
→ ruci → āsakti → bhāva → PREMA

Faith → *devotee association* → *practice* → *clearing the unwanted* → *steadiness* → *taste* → *attachment* → *emotion* → *love*. Notice that anartha-nivṛtti (Chapter 18) sits early on the path, and *ruci* (taste, Chapter 15) only after it — a map that quietly

reassures the struggling chanter of Chapter 3: dryness is not the end of the road but a stretch of it.

The mango seed

A child plants a seed and next morning asks, "Where is the mango?" First the sprout, then sapling, tree, flower, green fruit, ripening — perhaps fifteen years. "Don't demand fruit from a seed," says the grandfather. "Tend the tree with love. The fruit will come."

21.3 The Signs of Prema

External	Internal
tears while chanting	constant remembrance of Kṛṣṇa
the voice chokes speaking of Him	cannot bear separation
hair stands on end	nothing else seems important
spontaneous chanting and dancing	Kṛṣṇa seen everywhere

21.4 The Return of Kṛṣṇa Dāsa

Recall the devotee of Chapter 3 — fifteen years, no taste, no tears. He did not chant *more*; he cleared, one by one, the clouds this book has named. And the change, when it came, was not that the name grew stronger. "The name didn't change," his guru had said. "**You** changed."

This is the whole of *Nāma-Tattva* in a sentence. My chanting was never failing because the name was weak. It was blocked, and blockages have names, and named things can be cleared. The sun was always full. The work was only ever to open the sky.

From the lectures. Sacīnandana Swami Mahārāja names the goal without flinching: the *prayojana* is to awaken love for Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa, abandoning the material consciousness that shrinks us; and he traces how attentive, humble chanting ripens — at Ṭer Kadamba, at the feet of Rūpa Gosvāmī — into that very love. This is where the Name was always leading.

Coda

*he kṛṣṇa karuṇā-sindho dīna-bandho jagat-pate gopeśa gopikā-kānta rādhā-kānta
namo 'stu te*

*O Kṛṣṇa, ocean of mercy, friend of the fallen, Lord of the universe, beloved of the gopīs,
beloved of Rādhā — I bow to You.*

**Hare Kṛṣṇa Hare Kṛṣṇa Kṛṣṇa Kṛṣṇa Hare Hare / Hare Rāma Hare Rāma
Rāma Rāma Hare Hare**

— end of the twenty-one chapters —

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Glossary of Sanskrit Terms

Terms are given in IAST. Definitions are concise and keyed to how the term is used in this book; chapter references point to where the term is central.

Term	Meaning
abhidheya	The <i>process</i> — the practice (chanting, hearing) that connects the soul to Kṛṣṇa; the middle of the sambandha–abhidheya–prajojana arc.
abhinnatva	Non-difference; the principle that the holy name and the named (Kṛṣṇa) are one and the same. (Ch 1)
ācārya	A spiritual teacher who instructs by living example and stands in disciplic succession.
agha-kṣaya	The destruction of sin. (Ch 19)
ahaṅkāra	False ego — the misidentification "I am the doer / enjoyer," which links the soul to matter. (Ch 4)
anartha	An "unwanted thing" lodged in the heart — a residue of the enemies that obstructs the taste for the name. (Ch 5)
anartha-nivṛtti	The clearing away of anarthas, said to proceed in four degrees. (Ch 18)
aparādha	Offense; nāma-āparādha = the ten offenses to the holy name. (Ch 7)
āśraya / āhāra / nidrā / saṅga	shelter / food / sleep / association — lifestyle factors that shape consciousness. (Ch 15)
brāhma-muhūrta	The auspicious ~1.5-hour period before sunrise, when the mode of goodness predominates — the recommended time for chanting. (Ch 15)
bhakti	Loving devotional service to Kṛṣṇa.
bhakti-latā	The "creeper of devotion," grown through nine stages from faith to prema. (Ch 21)
damah	Self-control; subduing the senses and the inner enemies. (Ch 14)
guṇas	The three modes of material nature — <i>sattva</i> (goodness), <i>rajas</i> (passion), <i>tamas</i> (ignorance). (Ch 4, 15)
guṇa-saṅga	Association with / contact with the modes — the mechanism by which the soul is conditioned. (Ch 4)
japa	Soft, individual chanting of the mahā-mantra, usually counted on beads.
jīva	The individual living entity — Kṛṣṇa's eternal, minute part.

Term	Meaning
jitendriya	One who has conquered the senses. (Ch 17)
kīrtana / saṅkīrtana	Congregational chanting/singing of the holy names.
kṣamā	Forgiveness. (Ch 20)
Kṛṣṇa-prema	Pure love of Kṛṣṇa — the goal (prayojana) of all practice. (Ch 21)
laulyam	Intense spiritual greed or longing — the sole "price" of Kṛṣṇa-prema. (Ch 21)
mada	Pride, intoxication with one's position — one of the six enemies.
mahā-mantra	The "great mantra": <i>Hare Kṛṣṇa Hare Kṛṣṇa, Kṛṣṇa Kṛṣṇa Hare Hare / Hare Rāma Hare Rāma, Rāma Rāma Hare Hare</i> .
māna-dāna	Offering respect to others (from Śikṣāṣṭaka 3, <i>amāninā mānadena</i>). (Ch 12)
mātsarya	Envy — the subtlest of the six enemies.
māyā	The Lord's illusory material energy.
nāma	The holy name. nāma-nāminoḥ = "of the name and the named."
nāmābhāsa	The "shadow" of the name — a clearing but still-impure stage of chanting, between offensive and pure. (Ch 8)
nāma-aparādha	Offense to the holy name; the ten offenses. (Ch 7)
nāma-prabhāva	The potency / power of the holy name. (Ch 1)
nāma-roga-nirṇaya	"Diagnosis of the disease (that blocks) the name" — the book's self-diagnostic chapter. (Ch 9)
nāma-ruci	Taste for the holy name. (Ch 15)
nāma-uddhāra	Deliverance / uplift by the holy name. (Ch 2)
nāma-vighna	Obstacle to (the fruition of) the name. (Ch 3)
niraparādha	Offenseless (chanting). (Ch 13)
pāpa	Sin. (Ch 6)
paramparā	Disciplic succession — the chain through which teachings are transmitted intact.
pramāda	Inattention / heedlessness — the chief daily enemy of japa.
prayojana	The ultimate goal — Kṛṣṇa-prema.
ṣaḍ-ripu	The "six enemies": <i>kāma</i> (lust), <i>krodha</i> (anger), <i>lobha</i> (greed), <i>moha</i> (illusion), <i>mada</i> (pride), <i>mātsarya</i> (envy). (Ch 4)
sādhana	Regulated daily spiritual practice.

Term	Meaning
sādhū-saṅga	Association with saintly devotees.
sahiṣṇutā	Tolerance / forbearance (from Śikṣāṣṭaka 3, <i>taror api sahiṣṇunā</i>). (Ch 11)
sambandha	One's eternal relationship with Kṛṣṇa — the foundational knowledge.
samādhāya	"Having concentrated / settled" — fixing the mind in the heart (SB 8.3.1). (Ch 14)
śāstra	Revealed scripture.
śraddhā	Faith — the seed and starting point of devotional life.
śuddha-nāma	The pure name — the third and highest stage of chanting. (Ch 8)
taṭasthā	"Marginal" — the constitutional position of the jīva, able to face either energy. (Ch 4)
trṇād api sunīcena	"Lower than the straw in the street" — the humility of Śikṣāṣṭaka 3. (Ch 10)
vinaya	Humility. (Ch 10)
Vaiṣṇava-aparādha	Offense to a devotee — the gravest of the ten offenses. (Ch 7)

References & Sources

Nāma-Tattva: Why My Chanting Isn't Working (and How to Fix It)

This edition follows the paramparā method: **no speculation** — **only śāstra and the ācāryas**. Verse transliterations and English translations follow the standard Bhaktivedanta Book Trust editions as published on **Vedabase**. Every scriptural citation below was checked against Vedabase / Vāṇisource during a dedicated verification pass; the status column records the result.

1. Scriptural sources

Text	Abbrev.	Used in
Bhagavad-gītā As It Is	BG	Ch 4, 6, 11, 15, 17, 20
Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam	SB	Ch 1, 2, 6, 14, 18, 19
Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta	Cc	Ch 2, 21
Śikṣāṣṭaka (Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu)	—	Ch 1, 10, 12
Padma Purāṇa	—	Ch 1, 7
Padyāvalī (Rūpa Gosvāmī)	—	Ch 21
Hari-bhakti-sudhodaya	—	Ch 2 (Dhruva)
Mādhurya-kādambinī (Viśvanātha Cakravartī Ṭhākura)	—	Ch 3, 7, 9, 18
Harināma Cintāmaṇi / Bhajana-rahasya (Bhaktivinoda Ṭhākura)	—	Ch 5, 8

2. Citation verification log

Chapter	Verse cited	Reference	Status
1	<i>nāmnām akāri bahudhā...</i>	Śikṣāṣṭaka 2	✓ verified
1	<i>nāma cintāmaṇiḥ kṛṣṇaś...</i>	Padma Purāṇa (also Cc Madhya 17.133)	✓ verified

Chapter	Verse cited	Reference	Status
1, 2	<i>sāṅketyaṁ pārihāsyam...</i>	SB 6.2.14	✓ verified
2	<i>patitaḥ skhalito bhagnaḥ...</i>	SB 6.2.15	✓ verified
2	<i>kācam vicinvann api divya-ratnam...</i> (Dhruva)	Hari-bhakti- sudhodaya 7.28, quoted in SB 4.9.5 purport	⚠ corrected (was "SB 4.9.10")
2, 11	<i>naivodvije para...</i> (Prahlaḍa)	SB 7.9.43	✓ verified
3, 9	<i>bhagavan-nāmnī saṁprāpte 'parādhe...</i>	Mādhurya-kādambinī (teaching rendered in Sanskrit)	⚠ corrected (dropped false "3.19"; wording to confirm against the Sanskrit prose)
4	<i>kāma eṣa krodha eṣa...</i>	BG 3.37	✓ verified
4	<i>mamaivāṁśo jīva-loke...</i>	BG 15.7	✓ verified
4	<i>tri-vidham narakasyedam...</i>	BG 16.21	✓ verified
5	<i>tadā rajas-tamo-bhāvāḥ kāma-lobhādayaś ca ye...</i>	SB 1.2.19	✓ verified
6	<i>...dyūtaṁ pānam striyaḥ sūnā...</i>	SB 1.17.38	✓ verified
10, 12	<i>trṇād api sunīcena...</i>	Śikṣāṣṭaka 3	✓ verified
14	<i>evaṁ vyavasito buddhyā samādhāya mano hṛdi...</i>	SB 8.3.1	✓ verified
15	<i>sattvaṁ rajas tama iti...</i>	BG 14.5	✓ verified
15	<i>mām ca yo 'vyabhicāreṇa...</i>	BG 14.26	✓ verified
17	<i>rāga-dveṣa-viyuktais tu...</i>	BG 2.64	✓ verified
19	<i>ayaṁ hi kṛta-nirveśo janma-koṭy-amhasām api...</i>	SB 6.2.7	✓ verified
20	<i>sarva-dharmān parityajya...</i>	BG 18.66	✓ verified
21	<i>kṛṣṇa-bhakti-rasa- bhāvitā matiḥ...</i> (lauḷyam)	Rūpa Gosvāmī, Padyāvalī 14; Cc Madhya 8.70	⚠ corrected (was "Cc Madhya 22.42" — which is in fact the <i>Dhruva</i> verse)

Note for the final print pass: the remaining paraphrased ācārya-prose epigraphs (Ch 8, 11, 15, 18) are marked "(paraphrased)" in-text and should be replaced with exact quotations from a verified edition where a publisher requires verbatim sourcing; and the Sanskrit rendering of the Mādhurya-kādambinī principle (Ch 3, 9) should be checked against the Sanskrit prose.

3. Contemporary lecture sources (the corpus)

The "From the lectures" panels and the contemporary-teacher epigraphs draw on a corpus of recorded Holy-Name lectures by three ISKCON teachers, sourced from **ISKCON Desire Tree** (audio.iskcondesiretree.com), transcribed with OpenAI Whisper (large-v3-turbo) and enriched into study notes.

Transcripts & enriched notes (open repository):

<https://github.com/SreeGD/sadhana-setu> — see corpus/transcripts/ (verbatim transcripts) and corpus/notes/ (enriched notes).

Teacher	Repository path	Cited as
HH Sacinandana Swami Mahārāja	corpus/transcripts/sacinandana- maharaja/ · corpus/notes/sacinandana- maharaja/	Ch 1, 3, 4, 5, 7, 8, 10, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16, 18, 20, 21
HG Vaiṣeṣika Prabhu	corpus/transcripts/holy-name-seminar/ · corpus/notes/holy-name-seminar/	Ch 1, 2, 3, 4, 14, 15
HG Bhūrijana Prabhu	corpus/transcripts/bhurijana-prabhu/ · corpus/notes/bhurijana-prabhu/	Ch 2, 4, 6, 9, 13, 16
HG Mahātmā Prabhu	corpus/transcripts/mahatma-prabhu/	Appendix H (technique)

Provenance of contemporary quotations. Direct quotations attributed to a contemporary teacher (e.g., Bhūrijana Prabhu, "Be determined to hear one mantra"; Vaiṣeṣika Prabhu, "Bring your mind back to the mantra itself") are **verbatim lines from the linked transcripts**. Statements marked "(as taught in ...)" summarize a teaching from the named lecture rather than quoting it word-for-word. The full note→chapter mapping is in **TOC.md**, **Appendix J**.

All glories to Śrī Guru and Gaurāṅga. Any error in citation is the compiler's alone and will be corrected in a subsequent printing.

DRAFT